

Academic Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students begin by examining various aspects of Canada's ecozones. Students will create a tourism brochure outlining which ecozone in Canada is the best place to live. The brochure will outline the landforms, climate, vegetation, wildlife, and the human activities occurring within the chosen ecozone. In their brochure, students are to justify why in their opinion this ecozone is the best place to live or visit. Justification can include employment, recreational opportunities, standard of living or any other criteria they feel is important. The completed brochure is to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams, or pictures.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from three strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Human-Environment Interactions; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. identify the best place in Canada to live, using a reasoned argument to justify this choice;
2. demonstrate an understanding of how natural and human systems interact within ecozones;
3. produce a set of criteria for identifying regions, including ecozones;
4. demonstrate an understanding of how natural systems (e.g., climate, soils, landforms, natural vegetation, wildlife) influence cultural and economic activities (e.g., recreation, transportation, employment opportunities);
5. create and use effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams;
6. use geographic data to support conclusions and opinions.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- knowledge of the definition of an ecozone
- knowledge of some of Canada's ecozones and their physical characteristics (e.g. landforms, climate, vegetation, and soils)
- relate the landforms, climate, vegetation, and human activities to ecozones in different parts of the country
- understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials
- ability to read, analyse, and interpret graphs and maps
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research

Task Rubric – Canada’s Ecozones a good place to live

Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50 – 59)	Level 2 (60 –69)	Level 3 (70 – 79)	Level 4 (80-100)
<u>Knowledge / understanding</u>					
2, 4	Demonstrates understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates limited understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates some understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates considerable understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates thorough understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems
<u>Thinking / Inquiry</u>					
3	- Uses a variety of relevant supporting facts and details - Explains the significance of the information selected	- Uses a limited variety of relevant supporting facts and details - Explains the significance to a limited degree	- Uses some variety of relevant supporting facts and details - Explains the significance to some degree	- Uses a considerable variety of relevant supporting facts and details - Explains the significance to a considerable degree	- Uses a wide variety of relevant supporting facts and details - Explains the significance to a high degree
<u>Communication</u>					
5	Creates and uses effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	Uses to a limited effect photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	Uses to some effect photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	Uses to a considerable effect photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams	Creates and uses effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams
<u>Application</u>					
1, 6	Uses geographic data to support a reasoned argument	Uses little geographic data to support a reasoned argument	Uses some geographic data to support a reasoned argument	Uses considerable geographic data to support a reasoned argument	Uses a high degree of geographic data to support a reasoned argument